ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — ENGLISH · CLASS 8 · SET 01

Max. Marks 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Any other correct answer in the student's own words to be accepted

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

The Living Root Bridges of Meghalaya

In the rainy hills of Meghalaya, the Khasi and Jaintia people have crossed deep streams for centuries on bridges that no engineer ever built with steel or stone. These bridges are grown, not constructed. The people guide the long, strong roots of the Indian rubber fig tree across a river using bamboo scaffolding and hollowed tree trunks. Slowly, over ten to fifteen years, the roots thicken, twine together and take root on the far bank.

Unlike an iron bridge, a living bridge becomes stronger with age. Some of them are more than five hundred years old and can carry the weight of fifty people at a time. When floods damage a part of the bridge, the roots simply grow back. Villagers regard these bridges as a shared inheritance, and each generation looks after the bridges planted by its grandparents.

1. Which tree is used to grow the living root bridges?

(a) Banyan tree (b) Indian rubber fig tree
(c) Bamboo tree (d) Peepal tree

Ans: (b) Indian rubber fig tree

2. According to the passage, why is a living bridge different from an iron bridge?

(a) It is cheaper to paint (b) It becomes stronger as it gets older
(c) It is built within a week (d) It cannot carry any weight

Ans: (b) It becomes stronger as it gets older

3. How long does it take for the roots to grow across the river?

(a) Two to three years (b) Five to six years
(c) Ten to fifteen years (d) More than five hundred years

Ans: (c) Ten to fifteen years

4. What happens when floods damage a part of a living bridge?

(a) The bridge is abandoned (b) The roots grow back
(c) Steel rods replace it (d) A new bridge is built

Ans: (b) The roots grow back

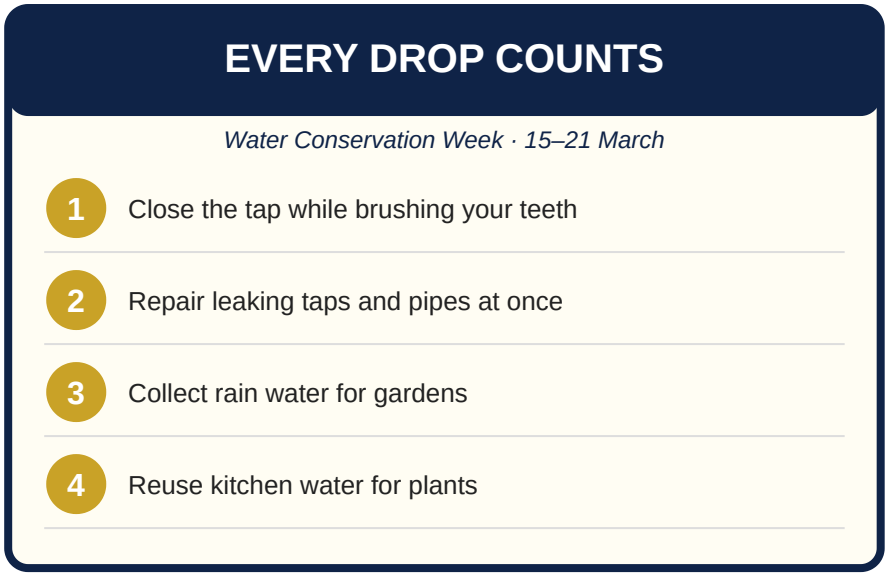
5. Why do the villagers regard the living root bridges as a 'shared inheritance'? Answer in two points.

Ans: Each generation looks after the bridges planted by grandparents / the bridges are used by the whole community and passed on to future generations (any two points, 1 mark each).

6. How do the people guide the roots across the river?

Ans: They use bamboo scaffolding and hollowed tree trunks.

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



India receives most of its rain in just three or four months, yet millions of families face water shortage every summer. Groundwater levels are falling because we draw water faster than nature can refill it. A single leaking tap can waste more than a thousand litres in a month. The poster issued by the school Eco Club shows that simple habits, practised by every member of a family, can save thousands of litres of water in a year.

1) According to the passage, why do many families face water shortage in summer?

(a) It never rains in India
(b) Most rain falls in only a few months
(c) People drink too little water
(d) Rivers flow backwards

Ans: (b) Most rain falls in only a few months

2) Which instruction on the poster would help most to stop water being wasted in a bathroom?

(a) Collect rain water
(b) Reuse kitchen water
(c) Close the tap while brushing
(d) Plant more trees

Ans: (c) Close the tap while brushing

3) A school canteen has a dripping tap. Which action is most suitable according to the poster?

(a) Ignore it as it is a small leak
(b) Repair it at once
(c) Cover it with a cloth
(d) Use more buckets

Ans: (b) Repair it at once

4) The poster is most likely to be displayed in:

(a) a cinema hall
(b) a school corridor
(c) an airport runway
(d) a bank locker room

Ans: (b) a school corridor

5) How do the passage and the poster complement each other? Give two points.

Ans: The passage explains why saving water is necessary (shortage, falling groundwater, wastage from leaks); the poster shows how to do it through simple habits / the poster presents the information in short, quick-to-read points (any two, 1 mark each).

6) Why does the poster use numbers and short sentences?

Ans: To make the instructions clear, easy to read and easy to remember.

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. (4x1=4)

1) Ria was feeling cold, so she _____ her jacket before going out.

(a) took off (b) put on
(c) gave up (d) turned off

> **Ans:** (b) put on

2) The doctor asked him to _____ eating junk food.

(a) give up (b) put up
(c) take after (d) look into

> **Ans:** (a) give up

3) Please _____ the lights when you leave the room.

(a) turn off (b) put on
(c) give in (d) run out

> **Ans:** (a) turn off

4) Aman has promised to _____ his younger brother while their parents are away.

(a) look after (b) look up
(c) put off (d) take away

> **Ans:** (a) look after

5) The match had to be _____ because of heavy rain.

(a) called off (b) called up
(c) called on (d) called in

> **Ans:** (a) called off

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (4x1=4)

6) Identify the adjective that describes the bag in the sentence: *The tall boy carried a heavy bag.*

(a) tall (b) boy
(c) heavy (d) carried

> **Ans:** (c) heavy

7) Choose the sentence that uses the adjective correctly.

(a) This is the most easiest sum.
(b) Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.
(c) She is more taller than me.
(d) He is the most strongest boy.

> **Ans:** (b) Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.

8) Adjectives are words that describe nouns and pronouns.

(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** True

9) Gold is _____ than silver. *(heavier / heaviest / heavy)*

> **Ans:** heavier

10) Rohit is the _____ student in the class.

(a) good (b) better

(c) best (d) more good

> **Ans:** (c) best

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

11) Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. My sister _____ (read) a book every night.

> **Ans:** reads

12) A verb is a word that shows an action, a state of being or possession.

(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** True

13) Choose the correct verb: The children _____ in the park yesterday evening.

(a) plays (b) play

(c) played (d) playing

> **Ans:** (c) played

14) Identify the verb in the sentence: *The little bird sang sweetly in the garden.*

(a) little (b) bird

(c) sang (d) sweetly

> **Ans:** (c) sang

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

15) Choose the correct modal verb: You _____ stop at a red signal.

(a) may (b) must

(c) might (d) could

> **Ans:** (b) must

16) Fill in the blank with a suitable modal: _____ I come in, madam?

> **Ans:** May / Can

17) Modal verbs are used to express ability, permission, possibility, advice or necessity.

(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** True

18) Choose the sentence with the correct use of a modal verb.

(a) He can swims fast. (b) She must goes now.

(c) We should help the poor. (d) They may plays outside.

> **Ans:** (c) We should help the poor.

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) — 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) Draft a notice for the school notice board in about 50 words informing the students of classes VI–VIII about an Inter-House Quiz Competition to be held on 10 November. You are Anil/Anita, the Secretary of the Literary Club.

> **Sample answer (about 50 words):**
> **GREEN VALLEY PUBLIC SCHOOL**
> **NOTICE** 2 November 2026
> **Inter-House Quiz Competition**
> The Literary Club announces an Inter-House Quiz Competition for students of Classes VI–VIII on 10 November 2026 at 11:00 a.m. in the school auditorium. Each House may send a team of three students. Interested students should give their names to the House Captain by 6 November.
> Anil, Secretary, Literary Club
> *Marking: Format (heading, date, title, signature) 2; content (what, when, where, who, last date) 3; language 1.*

O R

(B) Narrate an incident when you overcame your fear and did something brave. Mention what you were afraid of, what you did, how others reacted and what you learnt, in 100–120 words.

> **Sample answer (100–120 words):**
> Last summer I was terrified of deep water. During our school picnic, my friends jumped into the shallow end of the swimming pool and called me to join them. My legs trembled and my heart raced. Then I remembered my swimming coach's words: 'Fear becomes smaller when you face it.' I took a deep breath, held the rail and stepped into the water. Slowly I let go and floated for a few seconds. My friends clapped and cheered, and my teacher smiled proudly. That day I learnt that courage does not mean having no fear; it means moving ahead in spite of it.
> *Marking: Content (all four points) 3; organisation and fluency 2; accuracy of language 1.*

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) You are Mohan/Mona, a resident of Rajendra Nagar, Jaipur. Write a letter to the Editor of a local newspaper in 100–120 words about the loud music played in your neighbourhood late at night, which disturbs students preparing for examinations. Suggest ways to control it.

> **Sample answer (100–120 words):**
> 25 Rajendra Nagar
> Jaipur
> 2 November 2026
> The Editor
> The Daily Herald
> Jaipur
> Subject: Loud music at night disturbs students
> Sir,
> Through your newspaper I wish to draw the attention of the authorities to the loud music played late at night in our locality during marriages and parties. The noise continues till midnight and makes it very hard for students to study, especially during examinations. It also troubles patients and elderly people. I request the police to enforce the time limit for loudspeakers and urge residents to keep the volume low after 10 p.m.
> Thanking you
> Yours faithfully
> Mohan
> *Marking: Format (address, date, receiver, subject, salutation, close) 2; content 2; expression and accuracy 2.*

O R

(B) You want to join a school trip to the Science Museum in Delhi. Write a letter to your Principal in 100–120 words requesting permission, mentioning the date, the purpose of the visit, the arrangements and the fee.

Sample answer (100–120 words):
Class VIII B
Green Valley Public School
2 November 2026
The Principal
Green Valley Public School
Subject: Permission to join the educational trip
Respected Madam,
I request permission to join the educational trip to the National Science Museum, Delhi, on 20 November 2026. The trip will help us understand the topics of force, light and electricity through live models. I understand that the bus will leave at 6 a.m. and return by 8 p.m. under the supervision of our teachers, and that the fee of ₹450 is to be paid by 12 November. My parents have given their consent.
Yours obediently
Mohit
Marking: Format 2; content (date, purpose, arrangements, fee) 2; expression and accuracy 2.

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: (4x1=4)

Major Somnath Sharma of the 4th Kumaon Regiment was posted at Badgam, near Srinagar, in November 1947 when raiders were advancing towards the city. Although his left hand was in plaster after an injury, he insisted on leading his company. When the enemy attacked in great numbers, he ran from post to post, encouraging his men and even loading magazines for them. He fought till the last moment and was killed by a mortar shell, but his stand held up the enemy until reinforcements arrived and saved Srinagar airfield. He became the first recipient of the Param Vir Chakra.

a) Major Somnath Sharma belonged to the _____ Regiment. (4th Kumaon / Sikh Light Infantry) *(4th Kumaon / Sikh Light Infantry)*

Ans: 4th Kumaon

b) Major Sharma refused to lead his company because his hand was injured.
(State True or False.)

Ans: False

c) What was the result of his stand at Badgam?
(a) The airfield was captured
(b) Reinforcements reached in time
(c) The raiders surrendered
(d) The company retreated

Ans: (b) Reinforcements reached in time

d) He was the first recipient of the:
(a) Ashoka Chakra
(b) Param Vir Chakra
(c) Vir Chakra
(d) Padma Shri

Ans: (b) Param Vir Chakra

e) Why do you think Major Sharma insisted on leading despite his injury?

Ans: He valued duty and the safety of the city over personal comfort / he wished to inspire his men (any suitable reason).

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: (2x2=4)

The old clock on the village wall
Ticks softly, never late at all;

It does not boast, it does not cry,
It simply serves as hours go by.

a) What does the old clock do?

> **Ans:** It ticks softly and tells the time / serves as hours go by. (2)

b) Pick out a word from the extract that means 'to praise oneself'.

> **Ans:** boast (2)

c) What quality of the clock does the poet admire?

> **Ans:** Its punctuality and quiet, steady service without complaint or show-off (2).

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. **(4x3=12)**

a) How does the story of Major Somnath Sharma continue to motivate both soldiers and ordinary citizens even today?

> **Ans:** Courage under pressure, putting duty before self, leading by example, first PVC; citizens can learn dedication to duty in their own fields (any three points, 1 mark each).

b) According to Verghese Kurien, how can individuals contribute to the 'common good' in their daily lives?

> **Ans:** By working honestly for community benefit, cooperating with others (like farmers' cooperatives), sharing resources/knowledge, and putting the group's welfare before personal gain (any three points).

c) How did Tenali Ramakrishna use his wit to win the hearts of the people of Vijayanagara?

> **Ans:** Used humour and clever solutions to problems, advised the king wisely, exposed folly without hurting anyone, helped the common people (any three points).

d) What does the poem 'Somebody's Mother' teach us about the behaviour of the young towards the old?

> **Ans:** Elders deserve kindness and help; one boy helped the old woman cross the street while others ignored her; true worth lies in compassion and courtesy (any three points).

e) 'True greatness lies in service.' Support this statement with reference to any ONE lesson from Unit 2.

> **Ans:** Any one of Major Somnath Sharma (service to the nation), Verghese Kurien (service to farmers) or the boy in 'Somebody's Mother' with two supporting details and a conclusion (3).